



Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's
SARDAR PATEL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
(Empowered Autonomous Institute Affiliated to University of Mumbai)
Munshi Nagar, Andheri (W), Mumbai – 400 058.

13th Academic Council Minutes of Meeting

The 13th Academic Council Meeting was held on 30th July 2026 at 11:00 a.m. in hybrid mode. On behalf of the Institute, the Chairperson welcomed all the esteemed members, Special Invitees, Faculty Representatives, Student Representatives, and other members of the Academic Council.

The following members attended the meeting:

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|---------------------------|---|----------------------------------|
| 1) Dr. B. N. Chaudhari | – | Chairman |
| 2) Dr. Reena S. Sonkusare | – | Member Secretary |
| 3) Dr. M. S. Sutoane | – | Special Invitee, IIT Allahabad |
| 4) Dr. B. Satyanarayana | – | Special Invitee, TIFR |
| 5) Dr. Hariram K. Chavan | – | Special Invitee, KJSIEIT, Mumbai |
| 6) Mr. Anand Chitre | – | Special Invitee, Barclays |
| 7) Dr. Rohin Daruwala | – | Special Invitee, VJTI, Mumbai |
| 8) Dr. A. G. Keskar | – | Special Invitee, VNIT Nagpur |
| 9) Dr. S. N. Dhage | – | Head of the Department CE |
| 10) Dr. D. R. Kalbande | – | Head of the Department CSE |
| 11) Dr. D. M. Patil | – | Head of the Department ASH |
| 12) Dr. Sukanya Kulkarni | – | Controller of Examinations |
| 13) Ms. Pallavi More | – | Registrar |
| 14) Mr. Vinod Sikka | – | Training and Placement Officer |
| 15) Dr. Y. S. Rao | – | Faculty Representative |
| 16) Dr. Manisha Bansode | – | Faculty Representative |
| 17) Dr. Rupali Sawant | – | Faculty Representative |

The following members were granted leave of absence:

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|----------------------------|---|----------------------------------|
| 1) Dr. Nutan Limaye | – | Special Invitee, ITUC Denmark |
| 2) Dr. Rajesh S. Pande | – | Special Invitee, RU Nagpur |
| 3) Mr. Aniruddha Ainapure | – | Special Invitee, JPMC |
| 4) Mr. Sudhakar Paulzagade | – | Special Invitee, Stealth Startup |
| 5) Dr. Hema Date | – | Special Invitee, NITIE Mumbai |
| 6) Dr. Faruk Kazi | – | Special Invitee, VJTI, Mumbai |
| 7) Dr. Vikas M. Phalle | – | Special Invitee, VJTI, Mumbai |



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The 13th meeting of the Academic Council was conducted online on 30th July 2026 at 11:00 a.m. to deliberate on the new curriculum structure and various academic matters related to SP-IT. Dr. Rupali Sawant, Associate Dean–Academics, welcomed the members of the Academic Council and the experts from across the country. She expressed her gratitude for their valuable presence and for sharing their collective experience of more than 40 years.

The Principal and Chairman of the Academic Council commenced the meeting with a welcome address, expressing gratitude to the esteemed members for sparing their valuable time to attend the meeting and for providing guidance throughout this academic journey. We are continuously upgrading our curriculum to align with national guidelines and meet evolving industry requirements. As technical education undergoes significant transformation driven by technological advancements, evolving industrial scenarios, artificial intelligence, and allied technologies, we are making sincere efforts to address the emerging challenges. With the adoption of the National Education Policy, we are also working towards implementing its vision and objectives in the true spirit.

This is an ongoing journey, and we are sincerely striving to make our curriculum as conducive as possible to fulfilling the objectives of the National Education Policy and promoting the holistic development of learners. We introduced an NEP-aligned curriculum in 2023; however, our campus had already initiated several NEP-inspired practices as early as 2020. In 2023, following state-level guidance, we further implemented several recommended measures.

For instance, in 2020, industry internships were introduced in the curriculum as an optional component, and students were encouraged to participate. In 2023, following the state's recommendation, internships were made compulsory. Similarly, several major curriculum changes were initiated in 2020 and further fine-tuned in 2023. During the implementation process, we also identified various challenges, particularly concerning the MDM concept. The curriculum includes humanities, open electives, multidisciplinary courses (MDMs), skill-enhancement courses, skill-based laboratory courses, and several other components. The diverse nomenclature and implementation requirements led to confusion among students and institutions. After careful deliberation, we have developed a revised curriculum framework, referred to as the 2026–27 iteration, which will introduce changes to the first and second-year curriculum. The third and fourth-year curricula will be revised subsequently. Under the new structure, the incoming first-year batch and the current second-year batch will be covered. Dean–Academics, Dr. Reena, will present the revised structure and discuss the first- and



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second-year curricula, while also providing an overview of the proposed framework for the subsequent years.

We sincerely appreciate the presence of the esteemed academicians and industry experts on the Academic Council. SP-IT has progressed significantly with your continued support and mentorship, and we are confident that your valuable experience and guidance will help us move forward. Dr. Reena, welcomed all the Academic Council members and briefed them about the agenda of the meeting.

1. Confirmation of minutes of the 12th AC meeting held on 30th August 2025 in hybrid mode.

The minutes of the 12th meeting of the Academic Council were circulated to the honorable members through email prior to the meeting and were also annexed as annexure A of the Agenda of 13th meeting. The members reviewed the minutes and noted the deliberations related to curriculum revisions, Board of Studies recommendations, examination reforms, result analysis, internship and placement statistics, academic planning and student achievements. Dr. B. N. Chaudhari, Chairman, observed that the suggestions and recommendations arising from the previous meeting had been duly considered and incorporated, wherever applicable, in the subsequent academic and curriculum-related activities. Members confirmed the minutes circulated as there was no further suggestion or discussion over the minutes.

Resolution 01/17: The minutes of the 12th meeting of the AC as enclosed in annexure A of the Agenda for 13th meeting are confirmed.

2. Approval of Curriculum Structure for Batch 2025-29 & 2026-30.

Dr. Reena presented SP-IT's Liberal PI Model of Engineering Education, which reflects our commitment to implementing the holistic vision of NEP 2020. Although NEP was formally announced in 2020, SP-IT was an early adopter, introducing its first holistic curriculum in 2021. The curriculum now enters its third iteration, refined for the 2025 and 2026 intake batches. The new Curriculum Structure was circulated to the honorable members through email prior to the meeting and was also annexed as annexure B of the Agenda of 13th Academic Council meeting.

Following the conferment of autonomy in 2017-18, SP-IT reduced its curriculum credits from approximately 180-188 to 160 in 2020-21, followed by a second revision in 2023.



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The latest curriculum was developed through extensive consultations with industry, faculty, and students, along with benchmarking against leading national and international institutions. The PI model is founded on outcome-based education, flexibility, and multidisciplinary learning. It combines strong professional engineering competencies with a compulsory minor in another discipline and liberal learning, while promoting design thinking, digital competence, sustainability, ethics, communication, and critical thinking. With nearly 50% choice-based learning, experiential components, laboratory work, projects, and internships, the curriculum enables students to pursue individualized and holistic learning pathways. The curriculum offers multiple pathways, including an Honours by Research track supported by summer internships and mentored research. Students completing a minimum of 160 credits are awarded a four-year engineering degree with a multidisciplinary minor. High-achieving students may pursue Honours by Research by earning 18 additional research credits during summer breaks and maintaining a CGPA of 8.25 or obtain an Honours certification by meeting the prescribed academic and GATE performance criteria.

In line with NEP 2020, the curriculum also provides multiple exit options: a certificate after one year and a summer workshop, a diploma after two years, an undergraduate degree after three years, and the full engineering degree upon completing the four-year programme. The 160-credit framework is distributed across programme-related courses and experiential learning (54%), basic and engineering sciences (17.5%), open electives (approximately 17%), and skill-enhancement courses (approximately 12%). This structure embeds multidisciplinary learning throughout the degree and remains closely aligned with the GR recommendations, with a deviation of barely one percent. The curriculum structure has been revised for both the first and second years. Accordingly, the 2025–29 batch, which will enter its second year, and the 2026–30 batch, which will commence its first year, will follow the revised structure.

In the first year, Semesters I and II are designed to build a strong foundation through courses in mathematics, digital systems, basic electrical and electronics engineering. The curriculum also includes skill-enhancement courses such as design thinking, engineering exploration, programming, data structures, laboratory work, and professional communication, along with liberal-learning courses on art of living, youth leadership, and harmony with nature. Students may also choose courses from basic science, engineering science, and open-elective baskets, with humanities subjects offered through the open-elective basket. Since SP-IT has eight divisions, different groups may be assigned different elective courses in Semesters I and II, as



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indicated by the oblique mark. The elective baskets include subjects such as Engineering Physics, Industrial Chemistry, Engineering Mechanics, Computer-Aided Engineering Drawing, Materials for EEE, and Biology for Engineers etc. The open-elective basket in the first and second semesters includes humanities subjects such as Political Science, Indian History, Philosophy, Economics, and foreign languages including German, Japanese, and French. These three-credit courses will be conducted primarily in person, with faculty support from the Bhavan's sister institute, and will include end-semester examinations.

In the second year, students will undertake Programme-core courses, mathematics, domain-specific laboratories, liberal-learning courses, and open electives. Lateral-entry students will complete bridge courses in mathematics to align their foundation with that of regular-entry students. The curriculum also includes AI-based real-life problem-solving, the Constitution of India, research credits for the Honours by Research pathway, and diverse liberal-learning options. Dr. Reena explained the proposed studio-mode courses across the semesters. She stated that suitable alternative evaluation mechanisms could be considered for students with CGPI above 8 and fast learners, with the involvement of industry professionals in the evaluation process.

In Semester V, students will complete 16 credits of Programme-core courses, along with open electives and experiential learning through a mini-project. Semester VI will include Programme-core and Programme-elective courses, open electives, a domain-specific laboratory, and a second mini-project. Students pursuing Honours by Research will undertake Research Stage II, carrying six credits, during the summer term after the third year.

Semester VII offers three pathways:

- **Option A:** Open electives, Programme electives, and the main project.
- **Option B:** Open electives, including Indian Knowledge and Value System, along with a research or industry internship.
- **Option C:** Open electives and Research Stage III, carrying 12 credits.

In Semester VIII, students will continue with the pathway appropriate to their Semester VII choice. The curriculum includes open electives, Programme electives, the main project, research or industry internships, and the final research stage for students pursuing Honours by Research.



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Dr. Sutaone asked whether you are presenting two curriculum structures. Dr. Reena explained that two curriculum iterations would be presented: the 2025–29 batch and the 2026–30 batch. The curriculum structure has been revised for both the first and second years. Accordingly, the 2025–29 batch, which will enter its second year, and the 2026–30 batch, which will commence its first year, will follow the revised curriculum structure.

Dr. Avinash Keskar sought clarification on whether students selecting one subject from the Basic Science and Engineering Science elective basket would be exempted from studying the others. He expressed concern that some students might complete engineering without formally studying physics, particularly in relation to advanced subjects such as Computational Electromagnetics. Dr. Reena clarified that the electives would be offered in a phased manner. In Semester I, only courses requiring no prior specialized background would be offered, while subjects such as Computational Electromagnetics and Signals and Systems would be introduced in Semester II. She further explained that students are expected to possess the required foundational knowledge of physics from their Class XII curriculum.

Dr. Keskar observed that Computational Electromagnetics could be relatively challenging for students. He suggested reviewing the subject with reference to the GATE syllabus and appropriately mapping the relevant topics. Dr. Daruwala suggested that the nomenclature of Computational Electromagnetics may be reviewed to ensure that it appropriately reflects the scope and level of the course.

Dr. Sutaone sought clarification regarding the inclusion of Multicolour in the curriculum. He emphasized that Physics and Mathematics should receive adequate representation and suggested that the curriculum should maintain appropriate alignment with the Electrical Engineering domain.

Dr. B. N. Chaudhari, Chairman, clarified that Advanced Physics would be introduced in subsequent semesters. He further explained that the proposed structure would include Principles of Electromagnetics, along with two to three Physics courses in the relevant course basket.

Dr. Reena presented the proposed Humanities, Social Sciences and Management (HSSM) courses. Dr. B. N. Chaudhari clarified that the HSSM courses were being sourced from the Bhavan sister institute and would be conducted in physical mode.



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The Council discussed how the open-elective baskets would lead to a multidisciplinary minor or MDM certification. Dr. Sutaoane suggested that courses from non-science, non-engineering and non-technology domains may appropriately be considered under the Minor component of the curriculum. Dr. B. N. Chaudhari elaborated on the proposed Minor structure and discussed the possibility of considering NPTEL courses as part of the curriculum framework. Dr. Daruwala advised that NPTEL courses should be carefully scrutinized for academic suitability before being incorporated into the Minor basket. Dr. Sutavane appreciated the flexibility provided to students through the Semester VII options.

Dr. Satyanarayana enquired about opportunities for students to undertake research work during the summer period. Dr. Reena provided the relevant information and explained the provision for research-oriented opportunities, including Honours by Research. Dr. Daruwala suggested exploring the concept of Vertical Integrated Projects (VIP) followed by foreign universities as a possible model for research-oriented learning. He recommended examining suitable international models. Dr. Sutavane suggested exploring the possibility of implementing such initiatives through collaboration with IIIT Allahabad.

Dr. B. N. Chaudhari explained that, although the institute has limited prior experience in implementing such a Programme, the Honours by Research pathway has been designed in accordance with government and university guidelines requiring 18 additional credits. To avoid overburdening students with extra coursework, these credits will be earned through a structured, multi-stage research experience during the summer terms. The journey will begin after the second year with research methodology, literature review, problem identification, and interaction with research guides. Students may undertake projects with SP-IT faculty or external research institutions such as the IITs and TIFR, progressing to longer research internships after the third year and throughout the final year. The pathway is optional and is intended to provide students with in-depth research exposure and an additional Honours certification. As implementation begins this year, the institute seeks guidance and collaboration from experienced academic and research institutions.

Dr. Satyanarayana suggested the inclusion of Quantum Sensing and recommended revision of the content related to Quantum Materials in view of emerging technological developments. Dr. Daruwala recommended inclusion of Communication-based Open Electives and Networking courses in the OE basket.



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Dr. Keskar sought clarification regarding the degree awarded to students under the proposed curriculum framework. Prof. Daruwala observed that the MDM courses were not explicitly reflected in the curriculum structure. Dr. Chaudhari clarified that the provision of Open Electives (OE) would include the relevant MDM courses. Dr. Keskar emphasized that the curriculum should provide adequate academic preparation for students appearing for discipline-specific subjects like GATE examinations.

Dr. D. M. Patil suggested that Design Thinking could be replaced by 3D Modelling and Printing to enhance practical and experiential learning. Dr. Reena suggested that the proposed component could appropriately be incorporated under Engineering Exploration. Dr. Reena requested the members to consider and approve the proposed curriculum structure.

Resolution 02(a)/13: The revised curriculum structure will apply to both the first- and second-year students. Students admitted in 2025–26 were initially following the earlier curriculum, in which we had identified gaps in areas such as Data Structures and Algorithms and soft skills. These gaps are being addressed through a two-month summer term, supported by external industry professionals.

Resolution 02(b)/13: As suggested by the AC members "Computational Electromagnetics" course name would be changed as "Principles of Electromagnetics" and its syllabus contents will be revised.

Resolution 02(c)/13: The Open Electives basket from semester 3 to 6 will collectively constitute the Multidisciplinary Minor (MDM) and it will be clearly specified in the final curriculum document as suggested by AC members.

Resolution 02(d)/13: As suggested by AC members Prof. Dharuwala, Dr. Satyanarayana, and a few industry experts will be invited to help plan the implementation of the Honours by Research pathway. Since implementation is scheduled for the coming summer, the institute has sufficient time to define clear milestones and deliverables after the second and third years, after the seventh semester, and upon completion of the programme. A detailed implementation plan will clearly outline the expected projects, outcomes, and deliverables at each stage.



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Resolution 02(e)/13: The curriculum team will review the indicative courses and curriculum frameworks emerging from the national Semiconductor and Quantum Missions. The course titles should be refined, in consultation with Dr. Satyanarayana's recommendations, to align with nationally accepted terminology and ongoing discussions in these emerging technology domains.

Resolution 02(f)/13: The Academic Council unanimously approved the revised Curriculum structure to be implemented from the academic year 2025-26 for the following batches 2025-29 and 2026-30.

3. Information about the discussions and resolutions of respective BoS meetings

The respective Boards of Studies (BoS) had conducted meetings to deliberate upon and finalize the curriculum structures and syllabi of the concerned programmes. The consolidated details of the discussions and resolutions of the BoS meetings were presented to the Academic Council as Annexure C – BoS Minutes of Meeting – EXTC, CSE, MCA and CE, Odd Semester 2026-27.

Dr. Reena presented the consolidated overview of the BoS proceedings and informed the Council that the EXTC Board of Studies had approved the curriculum structures for the batches 2025-29 and 2026-30, along with the syllabi for Semesters I to IV and VII to VIII. She further informed the Council that the Computer Engineering and CSE Boards of Studies had approved the curriculum structures for the batches 2025-29 and 2026-30 after detailed deliberations. In respect of the MCA programme, the revised scheme and syllabus for the 2026-28 batch were presented, with emphasis on alignment with the NEP 2020 framework.

During the discussion, Dr. Daruwala suggested incorporating interview preparation and aptitude-related topics into the MCA curriculum. He further recommended strengthening the Java Programming Laboratory by including foundational practical exercises and a command-line-based case study. The Academic Council considered the discussions and recommendations of the respective Boards of Studies and approved the same.

Resolution 03/13: The Academic Council noted and unanimously approved the minutes, curriculum structures, schemes and syllabi finalized by the respective Boards of Studies, as presented in Annexure C of the agenda.



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4. Approval of the Academic Plan (AY 2026-27)

Dr. Reena presented the Academic Year Plan for 2026-27 to the Academic Council which was circulated to the honorable members through email prior to the meeting and was also annexed as annexure D of the Agenda of 13th Academic Council meeting. She informed the Council that the Odd Semester commenced on 20th July 2026 and will continue up to 6th November 2026, with examinations scheduled from 23rd November 2026 onwards. The Even Semester is scheduled from 4th January 2027 to 23rd April 2027. She further informed the Council that the Academic Calendar for First Year is under finalization. The proposed Academic Calendar comprises pre-semester activities and a detailed semester schedule covering approximately 14 teaching weeks, mid-term examinations, parent-teacher interactions, project evaluations, practical and theory examinations, holidays, and other academic activities. The Academic Year Plan was presented to the Council for review and approval as Annexure D of the agenda. The Academic Council reviewed the proposed Academic Year Plan and discussed the various academic activities and timelines incorporated therein.

Resolution 04/13: The Academic Council unanimously approved the proposed Academic Year Plan for the Academic Year 2026-27, as enclosed in Annexure D of the agenda.

5. Information about the Result Analysis

Dr. Reena presented the Result Analysis of the undergraduate programmes to the Academic Council. She presented the five-year average CGPA analysis of the various branches and highlighted the overall academic performance of the Institute. The Council members reviewed the branch-wise performance and the overall undergraduate CGPA trends. Dr. Reena further presented the CGPA distribution of the 2026 graduating batch, including the percentage of students securing a CGPA of 8.25 and above, between 6.75 and 8.25, and below 6.75. The Council members discussed the overall academic performance of the graduating batch. The Council noted that the **overall average UG CGPA for 2025-26 was 8.45**. The programme-wise average CGPA was **8.56 for Computer Engineering, 8.29 for CSE-AIML, 8.37 for CSE-DS, and 8.56 for EXTC**.

Resolution 05/13: The Academic Council noted and approved the Result Analysis of the undergraduate programmes for the Academic Year 2025-26, as presented.



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6. Information about Internship and Placement Statistics

Dr. Reena presented the Internship and Placement Statistics for the relevant academic years to the Academic Council. She informed the Council that the Research Internship option was shifted from Semester VI to Semester VIII in 2026. Consequently, students were required to undertake their Semester VI academic activities at the Institute, resulting in no research internship participation during that academic year.

She presented the branch-wise Industry Internship Statistics for the academic years 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26. She further presented the Research Internship Statistics, including internships offered by reputed institutions such as IIT Bombay, IIT Patna, IIT BHU, BARC, TIFR, SPJIMR, and other reputed institutions. The Council noted the overall internship participation and discussed the opportunities available to students across different branches.

Dr. Reena then presented the branch-wise placement statistics, including the number of students opting for placements, number of students placed, highest CTC, lowest CTC, average CTC, median CTC, and placement percentage. The Academic Council reviewed the internship and placement performance and appreciated the opportunities provided to students through industry and research internships.

Resolution 06/13: The Academic Council noted the Internship and Placement Statistics and appreciated the placement performance of the Institute and the efforts undertaken by the Training and Placement Cell.

7. Information about Students' Achievements for AY 2025-26

Dr. Reena presented the details of Students' Achievements for the Academic Year 2025-26 to the Academic Council. She informed the Council that students had actively participated and achieved recognition in various hackathons, sports, cultural activities, academic competitions, and other co-curricular activities. The Council members appreciated the enthusiasm and active participation of the students in diverse activities.

Prof. Chaudhari, Chairman, appreciated the efforts of the students and faculty members in encouraging and supporting students to participate in various activities. He also highlighted the contribution of such activities towards the holistic development of students. The details of the students' achievements were presented as Annexure E of the agenda.



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Resolution 07/13: The Academic Council took note of the Students' Achievements for the Academic Year 2025-26 and appreciated the efforts of the students, faculty members, and the Institute in promoting and supporting student participation in various academic, co-curricular, and extracurricular activities.

8. Any Other Point of Discussion with the Permission of the Chairman

Dr. B. N. Chaudhari, Chairman, invited the members to raise any additional academic matters for discussion with the permission of the Chair.

Dr. Daruwala reiterated the importance of appropriately considering student engagement beyond classroom teaching while designing academic structures and determining credits. Dr. Sutaokane appreciated the flexibility offered to students through the revised curriculum, particularly the options available in Semester VII.

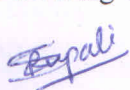
Dr. Satyanarayana emphasized the need to provide students with greater opportunities for research-oriented activities and highlighted emerging areas such as Quantum Sensing. Prof. Daruwala suggested exploring research-oriented academic models such as Vertical Integrated Projects (VIP) and strengthening collaborations with external institutions.

Dr. Chaudhari, Chairman, emphasized that the curriculum and academic initiatives should continue to evolve in accordance with NEP 2020, emerging technological developments, and the changing requirements of industry and higher education.

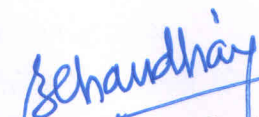
Resolution 08/13: The Academic Council took note of the suggestions and recommendations made by the members and agreed to consider these aspects while planning future updates in curriculum and academic initiatives.

The Chairman, Prof. B. N. Chaudhari, and Dr. Reena expressed their sincere gratitude to all the members for their participation, constructive deliberations, valuable insights, and thoughtful suggestions. Also thanked the members for their contributions and assured them that the recommendations would be considered and implemented in the best possible manner.

The meeting concluded with a vote of thanks to the Chair at 1.00 PM.


Dr. Rupali Sawant & Dr. Manisha Bansode
Associate Dean Academics


Dr. Reena Sonkusare
Dean Academics


Dr. B. N. Chaudhari
Principal